

rounds, but many were too high or failed to explode. The *Kearsarge* fired only 173 shots, but with her superior gunnery they had telling effect, first disabling the raider's steering mechanism and then tearing a gash in her side at the waterline. Water poured into the *Alabama*, and the ship struck her colors (lowered her flag as a sign of surrender) before sinking stern first. The *Kearsarge* recovered most of the survivors, but a number of the *Alabama*'s officers, including Semmes, were rescued by a British yacht and escaped to England. Seventeen crew members of the *Kearsarge* later received Medals of Honor for their actions, including Black seaman Joachim Pease.

Not a single U.S. merchant sailor lost his life as a result of the *Alabama*'s raids on commercial shipping.

Last of the raiders

James Bulloch, the Confederate agent, put one more famous raider to sea. Since tightened neutrality laws made it impossible to build another vessel in Britain, he converted one instead. The *Sea King* departed London in October 1864—ostensibly for Bombay and points east. Fitted with guns and munitions, she became CSS *Shenandoah*. Captained by James Waddell, the ship spent the next year cruising seas unexplored by former commerce raiders. Sailing south, she crossed from the Cape of Good Hope to Australia and then sailed far into the Pacific, where she preyed upon Yankee whalers venturing north to the Aleutian Islands and the Arctic Ocean. In June 1865, still taking prizes (37 in all), Waddell read in a newspaper about General Lee's surrender. On August 2, off the coast of California, he confirmed that the Confederacy had indeed collapsed. Disarming his ship, he avoided U.S. ports and steered for Cape Horn, and on to Britain, a voyage of some 19,000 miles (30,000km).

On November 5, 1865, the battered *Shenandoah* steamed up the Mersey River into the English port of Liverpool. At 10 a.m. the following day, the ship's ensign was hauled down—the last Confederate flag to be struck, and the only one to have